



Top five seeds in the Women's section

1. Georgia (2459) Captain:

Vladimir B Tukmakov
Nana Dzagnidze (2505); Nino Batsiashvili (2451); Lela Javakhishvili (2451); Bella Khotenashvili (2427); Salome Melia (2325)

2. India (2458) Captain: Abhijit Kunte

Harika Dronavalli (2491); R. Vaishali (2488); Divya Deshmukh (2464); Vantika Agrawal (2390); Tania Sachdev (2386)

3. Poland (2416) Captain:

Marcin Dziuba
Alina Kashlinskaya (2474); Monika Socko (2419); Aleksandra Maltsevskaya (2404); Oliwia Kiolbasa (2367); Alicja Sliwicka (2357)

4. China (2416) Captain: Yang Shen

Zhu Jiner (2469); Miaoyi Lu (2449); Yuxin Song (2383); Qi Guo (2362); Shiqun Ni (2352)

5. Azerbaijan (2414) Captain:

Mihail Shereshevsky
Gunay Mammadzada (2441); Govhar Beydullayeva (2412); Khanim Balajayeva (2404); Ulviyya Fataliyeva (2399); Gulnar Mammadova (2341)

returning to his homeland just two years after switching to Romania and the availability of veteran Peter Leko, is well-equipped to deliver some surprises. Meanwhile, Iran, led by Parham Maghsoodloo and backed by skilled GMs Amin Tabatabaei and Bardiya Daneshvar, has a team that could be very challenging to face.

India will field an equally strong lineup in the women's section, led by Dronavalli Harika, in the absence of Koneru Humpy, who opted out of



the tournament due to a packed schedule. As the second-seed team behind Georgia, India is well-positioned to make a strong impact. Abhijit Kunte will act as the non-playing captain for the women's team.

Newly minted GM R. Vaishali, who had an impressive outing at the Candidates', will be joining forces with Divya Deshmukh, the reigning World Junior Champion, along with Vantika Agrawal and Tania Sachdev.

Tania's return to competitive chess after a long hiatus will see her take up the fifth board. With Harika providing stability at the top and the dynamic duo of Vaishali and Divya adding flair, this Indian team brings a perfect mix of strength and flamboyance to the tournament.

The top-seeded Georgian team, rated at 2459, is spearheaded by Nana Dzagnidze, the only player in the world's top 10 competing in the women's section. She is supported by Nino Batsiashvili, Lela Javakhishvili, Bella Khotenashvili, and Salome Melia, making Georgia the rating favourite.

Meanwhile, third-seed Poland, led by Alina Kashlinskaya, and fifth-seed Azerbaijan will fancy their chances ahead of the usually heavyweight contenders Ukraine and China.

Defending champion Ukraine and the Chinese team have relatively inexperienced squads this time.

Sixth-seed Ukraine's title defence

Spearheading the challenge: India's women's team, led by Dronavalli Harika (in pic), will be without Koneru Humpy, who chose to skip the tournament due to a busy schedule.

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seems at risk following the withdrawal of the Muzychuk sisters (Anna and Mariya). Meanwhile, China, despite having the top four women's players — GMs Hou Yifan, Ju Wenjun, Lei Tingjie, and Tan Zhongyi — will be without all of them in the Olympiad, significantly weakening its challenge.

While Yifan has taken semi-retirement (she plays online) from competitive chess since 2018, Wenjun and Zhongyi will give the Olympiad a miss as they prepare for the women's world championship title.

The Chinese team is now led by GM Zhu Jiner, alongside 14-year-old national champion WGM Lu Miaoyi, making the path to gold potentially easier for the Indian team.

Liechtenstein, Guernsey, Grenada, St. Vincent and the Grenadines, St. Kitts and Nevis, the US Virgin Islands, St. Lucia, Nauru, and the Cayman Islands will make their debuts in the women's section in Budapest, while there will also be a refugee team.

The first round will start at 11:30 a.m. IST on September 11.